

Afflictions Made Beneficial.

In promoting the glory of God.

John 9:1-3. And as Jesus passed by, he saw a man which was blind from his birth. And his disciples asked him, saying, Master, who did Sin, this man, or his parents, that he was born blind? Jesus answered, Neither hath this man Sinned, nor his parents: but that the works of God should be made manifest in him.

John 11:3. Therefore his sisters sent unto him, saying, Lord, behold, he whom thou lovest is sick.

John 21:18-19. Verily, verily, I say unto thee, When thou wast young, thou girdedst thyself, and walkedst whither thou wouldest: but when thou shalt be old, thou shalt stretch forth thy hands, and another shall gird thee, and carry thee whither thou wouldest not. This spake he, signifying by what Death he should glorify God. And when he had spoken this, he saith unto him, Follow me.

In exhibiting the power and faithfulness of God.

Psalms 34:19-20. Many are the Afflictions of the Righteous: but the LORD delivereth him out of them all. 20 He keepeth all his bones: not one of them is broken.

2 Corinthians 4:8-11. We are troubled on every side, yet not distressed; we are perplexed, but not in despair; Persecuted, but not forsaken; cast down, but not destroyed; Always bearing about in the body the dying of the Lord Jesus, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest in our body. 11 For we which live are alway delivered unto Death for Jesus' sake, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest in our mortal flesh.

In teaching us the will of God.

Psalms 119:71. It is good for me that I have been Afflicted; that I might learn thy statutes.

Isaiah 26:9. With my soul have I desired thee in the night; yea, with my spirit within me will I seek thee early: for when thy judgments are in the earth, the inhabitants of the world will learn righteousness.

Micah 6:9. The LORDS' voice crieth unto the city, and the man of wisdom shall see thy name: hear ye the rod, and who hath appointed it.

In turning us to God.

Deuteronomy 4:30-31. When thou Art in Tribulation, and all these things are come upon thee, even in the latter days, if thou turn to the LORD thy God, and shalt be obedient unto his voice; (For the LORD thy God is a merciful God;) he will not forsake thee, neither destroy thee, nor forget the covenant of thy Fathers which he sware unto them.

In keeping us from again departing from God.

Job 34:31-32. Surely it is meet to be said unto God, I have borne chastisement, I will not offend any more: That which I see not Teach thou me: if I have done iniquity, I will do no more.

In leading us to seek God in prayer.

Judges 4:3. And the children of Israel cried unto the LORD: for he had nine hundred chariots of iron; and twenty years he mightily oppressed the children of Israel.

Jeremiah 31:18. I have surely heard Ephraim bemoaning himself thus; Thou hast chastised me, and I was chastised, as a bullock unaccustomed to the yoke: turn thou me, and I shall be turned; for thou Art the LORD my God.

Lamentations 2:17-19. The LORD hath done that which he had devised; he hath fulfilled his word that he had commanded in the days of old: he hath thrown down, and hath not pitied: and he hath caused thine enemy to rejoice over thee, he hath set up the horn of thine adversaries. Their heart cried unto the Lord, O wall of the daughter of Zion, let tears run down like a river day and night: give thyself no rest; let not the apple of thine eye cease. Arise, cry out in the night: in the beginning of the watches pour out thine heart like water before the face of the Lord: lift up thy hands toward him for the life of thy young children, that faint for hunger in the top of every street.

Hosea 5:14-15. For I will be unto Ephraim as a lion, and as a young lion to the house of Judah: I, even I, will tear and go away; I will take away, and none shall rescue him. I will go and

return to my place, till they acknowledge their offence, and seek my face: in their Affliction they will seek me early.

In convincing us of sin.

Job 36:8-9. And if they be bound in fetters, and be holden in cords of Affliction; Then he sheweth them their work, and their transgressions that they have exceeded.

In leading us to Confession of Sin.

Numbers 21:7. Therefore the people came to Moses, and said, We have Sinned, for we have spoken against the LORD, and against thee; pray unto the LORD, that he take away the serpents from us. And Moses prayed for the people.

Psalms 32:5. I acknowledged my Sin unto thee, and mine iniquity have I not hid. I said, I will Confess my transgressions unto the LORD; and thou forgavest the iniquity of my Sin. Selah.

Psalms 51:3. For I acknowledge my transgressions: and my Sin is ever before me.

Psalms 51:5. Behold, I was shapen in iniquity; and in Sin did my mother conceive me.

In testing and exhibiting our sincerity.

Job 23:10. But he knoweth the way that I take: when he hath tried me, I shall come forth as gold.

Psalms 66:10. For thou, O God, hast proved us: thou hast tried us, as silver is tried.

Proverbs 17:3. The fining pot is for silver, and the furnace for gold: but the LORD trieth the hearts.

In trying our faith and obedience.

Genesis 22:1-2. And it came to pass after these things, that God did tempt Abraham, and said unto him, Abraham: and he said, Behold, here I am. And he said, Take now thy son, thine only son Isaac, whom thou lovest, and get thee into the land of Moriah; and offer him there for a Burnt Offering upon one of the mountains which I will tell thee of.

In humbling us.

Deuteronomy 8:3. And he humbled thee, and suffered thee to hunger, and fed thee with

manna, which thou knewest not, neither did thy Fathers know; that he might make thee know that man doth not live by bread only, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of the LORD doth man live.

Deuteronomy 8:16. Who fed thee in the wilderness with manna, which thy Fathers knew not, that he might humble thee, and that he might prove thee, to do thee good at thy latter end;

2 Chronicles 7:13-14. If I shut up heaven that there be no Rain, or if I command the locusts to devour the land, or if I send pestilence among my people; If my people, which are called by my name, shall humble themselves, and pray, and seek my face, and turn from their wicked ways; then will I hear from heaven, and will forgive their Sin, and will heal their land.

In purifying us.

Ecclesiastes 7:2-3. It is better to go to the house of mourning, than to go to the house of feasting: for that is the end of all men; and the living will lay it to his heart. Sorrow is better than laughter: for by the sadness of the Countenance the heart is made better.

In exercising our patience.

Psalms 40:1. I waited patiently for the LORD; and he inclined unto me, and heard my cry.

Romans 5:3. And not only so, but we glory in Tribulations also: knowing that Tribulation worketh Patience;

James 1:3. Knowing this, that the trying of your Faith worketh Patience.

1 Peter 2:20. For what glory is it, if, when ye be buffeted for your faults, ye shall take it patiently? but if, when ye do well, and suffer for it, ye take it patiently, this is acceptable with God.

In rendering us fruitful in good works.

John 15:2. Every branch in me that beareth not fruit he taketh away: and every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit.

Hebrews 12:10-11. For they verily for a few days chastened us after their own pleasure; but

he for our profit, that we might be partakers of his holiness. Now no chastening for the present seemeth to be joyous, but grievous: nevertheless afterward it yieldeth the peaceable fruit of righteousness unto them which are exercised thereby.

In furthering the gospel.

Acts 8:3. As for Saul, he made havock of the Church, entering into every house, and haling men and Women committed them to prison.

Acts 11:19-21. Now they which were scattered abroad upon the persecution that arose about Stephen travelled as far as Phenice, and Cyprus, and Antioch, preaching the word to none but unto the Jews only. And some of them were men of Cyprus and Cyrene, which, when they were come to Antioch, spake unto the Grecians, preaching the Lord Jesus. And the hand of the Lord was with them: and a great number believed, and turned unto the Lord.

Philippians 1:12. But I would ye should understand, Brethren, that the things which happened unto me have fallen out rather unto the furtherance of the Gospel;

2 Timothy 2:9. Wherein I suffer trouble, as an evil doer, even unto bonds; but the word of God is not bound.

2 Timothy 4:16-17. At my first answer no man stood with me, but all men forsook me: I pray God that it may not be laid to their charge. Notwithstanding the Lord stood with me, and strengthened me; that by me the preaching might be fully known, and that all the Gentiles might hear: and I was delivered out of the mouth of the lion.

Exemplified.

Joseph's brethren,

Genesis 42:21. And they said one to another, We are verily guilty concerning our brother, in that we saw the anguish of his soul, when he Besought us, and we would not hear; therefore is this distress come upon us.

Joseph,

Genesis 45:5. Now therefore be not grieved, nor angry with yourselves, that ye sold me

hither: for God did send me before you to preserve life.

Genesis 45:7-8. And God sent me before you to preserve you a posterity in the earth, and to save your lives by a great deliverance. So now it was not you that sent me hither, but God: and he hath made me a Father to Pharaoh, and lord of all his house, and a ruler throughout all the land of Egypt.

Israel,

Deuteronomy 8:3. And he humbled thee, and suffered thee to hunger, and fed thee with manna, which thou knewest not, neither did thy Fathers know; that he might make thee know that man doth not live by bread only, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of the LORD doth man live.

Deuteronomy 8:5. Thou shalt also consider in thine heart, that, as a man chasteneth his son, so the LORD thy God chasteneth thee.

Josiah,

2 Kings 22:19. Because thine heart was tender, and thou hast humbled thyself before the LORD, when thou heardest what I spake against this place, and against the inhabitants thereof, that they should become a desolation and a curse, and hast rent thy clothes, and wept before me; I also have heard thee, saith the LORD.

Hezekiah,

2 Chronicles 32:25-26. But Hezekiah rendered not again according to the benefit done unto him; for his heart was lifted up: therefore there was wrath upon him, and upon Judah and Jerusalem. Notwithstanding Hezekiah humbled himself for the pride of his heart, both he and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, so that the wrath of the LORD came not upon them in the days of Hezekiah.

Manasseh,

2 Chronicles 33:12. And when he was in Affliction, he Besought the LORD his God, and humbled himself greatly before the God of his Fathers,

Jonah,

Jonah 2:7. When my soul fainted within me I remembered the LORD: and my prayer came in unto thee, into thine holy temple.

Prodigal son,

Luke 15:21. And the son said unto him, Father, I have Sinned against heaven, and in thy sight, and am no more worthy to be called thy son.